Table 1. Selected candidate-pool and caseload IV estimates

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Successor characteristic	Bachelor or above	985/211 school	No prior failure	No prior violation
Excluded instrument	Pool share	Pool share	Mean caseload	Mean caseload
Panel A. First stage				
Excluded-instrument coefficient	0.223***	0.224***	-0.0256**	-0.0363***
	(0.0602)	(0.0448)	(0.0107)	(0.0101)
Excluded-instrument F	13.71	24.95	5.76	12.87
First-stage p-value	0.000290	0.000002	0.018300	0.000530
Partial R-squared	0.00223	0.00218	0.00106	0.00213
Panel B. Second stage: successor year				
Any failure	-0.170*	-0.077	-0.283*	-0.166*
	(0.094)	(0.073)	(0.153)	(0.088)
Restatement	-0.041	-0.086*	-0.213*	-0.119**
	(0.042)	(0.045)	(0.121)	(0.053)
Violation	-0.147	-0.034	-0.131	-0.092
	(0.098)	(0.067)	(0.094)	(0.075)
Panel C. Second stage: successor tenure				
Any failure	-0.256**	-0.134	-0.147	-0.060
	(0.105)	(0.082)	(0.160)	(0.110)
Restatement	-0.127*	-0.116*	-0.101	-0.035
	(0.069)	(0.068)	(0.107)	(0.064)
Violation	-0.175*	-0.070	-0.032	-0.013
	(0.104)	(0.073)	(0.131)	(0.101)
Observations	25,359	24,686	10,656	10,668
Audit-firm clusters	168	162	96	96
Destination audit-firm / assignment-year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Financial controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: All matches; destination audit-firm and assignment-year fixed effects, financial controls, predecessor characteristic, pool size, and first-entry indicator included. Standard errors clustered by destination audit firm are in parentheses. Columns (1)–(2) use the candidate-pool share of the specified trait; columns (3)–(4) use mean caseload among candidates with the specified historical record. Caseload counts observed listed-company clients. First-year and tenure outcomes have different exposure horizons.

Selection: Among 54 trait-instrument-sample specifications in the current controlled candidate-pool output, retain specifications with first-stage $p < 0.05$ and at least one negative second-stage coefficient with $p < 0.10$. All four qualifying specifications and all six second-stage outcomes are shown. Columns (2)–(3) only reach the 10% level in the second stage; column (3) has first-stage F=5.76. This is a selected, exploratory display; reported significance is not adjusted for screening and does not establish instrument validity. Full results remain in the auditor-quality chapter.

*** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.10$.